The Payroll Investment and Transformation Report 2027

Research prospectus • Proposed first edition

Commissioned by JGA Recruitment Group with research support from Riseklix

What turns a payroll need into an investment decision

Payroll leaders may know what they want to improve. Getting a proposal evaluated, approved and delivered involves another set of decisions: who owns it, what evidence is needed, which alternatives are credible and what the organisation can implement.

This proposed report connects decisions with operational needs, including improvements that never become proposals. It builds on existing research and recent practitioner experience to examine the path from ambition to investment.

Two questions shape the research

What do leaders want but struggle to obtain? The capabilities, service expectations and improvements that matter, alongside what already works and should be preserved.

What determines whether change proceeds? The approval process, business case and delivery conditions behind investment, renewal, delay, rejection or abandonment.

The planned publication

Part One. Operating needs, technology and service gaps, and future priorities distinguished from approved commitments.

Part Two. Decision ownership, credible evidence, constraints and choices about staying, switching or changing a process. Approval and go-live will be distinguished from observed benefits.

From Ambition to Investment. A practical Payroll Investment Decision Framework that brings the findings together for leaders assessing their next proposal.

Intended readers

Senior employer-side payroll leaders and the finance, HR and technology stakeholders who assess payroll investment. The proposed initial focus is UK-relevant responsibilities, including international remits and employer-side users of outsourced payroll.

How the research will be useful

Evidence and practitioner experience

The research will combine referenced industry sources, original analysis and a target of 6–10 distinct verified senior payroll practitioner contributions through JGA introductions, subject to availability and permission.

Conversations or structured written contributions will examine a recent real decision where available. Successful projects, sensible renewals and deliberate no-change decisions are relevant alongside delayed or abandoned proposals. These contributions provide explanation and context rather than representative market estimates.

What readers will be able to use

- A clear account of priorities, gaps and purchasing realities, with the evidence behind each finding.
- Decision-case insights that connect the initial need with the evidence, people and conditions affecting the outcome.
- A reusable framework to help structure a proposal, assess alternatives and identify what is needed before proceeding.
- A concise executive summary, original graphics and transparent source and method notes.

Help shape the first edition

We would welcome feedback on three points:

1. Which specific business decision, if any, could this research help you make?

2. What evidence, context or unanswered question would determine whether it is useful? What would duplicate material you already have?

3. For commercial research buyers: how do you currently obtain this insight, and who evaluates a purchase? For practitioners: would contributing be worthwhile, and what would make participation practical?

Publication and participation

This is an early prospectus, not completed findings or a final commercial offer. Publication and potential licensing arrangements will be defined separately. Participation is voluntary; named quotations and employer identification require separate permission.

The report will also inform a separate assessment of The Table, a proposed research council and possible event-supported model. No event programme or partner commitments are being announced through this prospectus.

For feedback and contribution enquiries, contact Nick Day at JGA Recruitment Group or Satwik Kumar at satwik@riseklix.com.